

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

The weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 18 September 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

Generated Sat 19 Sep 2026 (HKT). Note: report fired shortly before Friday's US cash close (04:00 Sat HKT); index/price levels are anchored to the latest confirmed close (Thu 17 Sep, or Wed 16 Sep for the Dow) with week-to-date moves off Fri 11 Sep. Verify Friday's settle before acting.

1. Weekly Market Snapshot

Levels = latest confirmed close (Thu 17 Sep unless noted). Week move = change vs Fri 11 Sep close.

Instrument	Level	Week	Note
S&P 500	7,596	−0.8%	Whipsawed around Wed's Fed hike; Thu bounce trimmed the loss
Nasdaq Composite	25,978	−1.4%	Megacaps flat-to-lower; AI-chip leadership wobbled
Dow Jones (Wed 16 close)	51,462	−2.1%	Worst of the majors; −631 pts on Fed day. Thu/Fri rebound not fully captured
US 10Y yield	5.01%	higher	Touched ~5.00% (cycle high) on hawkish hike/dots; eased into Fri
US 2Y yield	4.73%	higher	Front end repriced to 'higher-for-longer' after the hike
Dollar (DXY)	~99.9	firmer	Bid on the hike; held just under 100
Gold	\$4,385	+~1%	Resilient near records; inflation hedge vs higher real yields. +19% y/y
Silver	~\$66.3	flat	Holding near multi-decade highs
Brent crude	\$104.6	−1.4%	First weekly loss in 3 wks as Saudi pipeline-restart hopes eased
WTI crude	~\$101–103	+~1%	Off six-week highs but still >\$100
Bitcoin	~\$78–81k	−5%	Risk-off; hurt by higher-for-longer repricing

Levels cross-checked against CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Washington Post index recap, Trading Economics, Kitco/goldprice.org and FXStreet. Some Friday figures were still intraday at generation; treat as provisional.

2. TL;DR

The Fed hiked. On Wednesday the Federal Reserve raised the funds rate 25bp to **3.75–4.00%** — its first increase since 2023 — and a hawkish dot plot flagged more to come, driven by oil-fuelled inflation (August CPI +3.4% y/y, gasoline +27% y/y). Equities sold off hard midweek (Dow −631 on the day), the 10Y kissed **5.00%**, and the dollar firmed. A Thursday–Friday relief bounce, helped by cooling crude as Saudi pipeline fears eased, pared the damage but left the majors lower on the week. Energy led; rate-sensitive cyclical and crypto lagged.

3. The Big Picture — What The Week Meant

1) The Fed hiked into an oil shock — the regime has flipped

Wednesday's 25bp move to 3.75–4.00% (unanimous vote) ended a two-and-a-half-year pause and reversed the market's rate-cut narrative outright. The trigger is supply-side: a

Middle East oil crisis has pushed gasoline +27% y/y and dragged headline CPI back up to 3.4%. The dot plot showed a strong majority (16 of 18) penciling at least one further hike this year.

***Read:** This is a rates-up, inflation-up regime, not the disinflationary glide path bulls were positioned for. Duration and long-duration equity (unprofitable tech, crypto) are the wrong place to be; real assets and cash-flow-now names are the right one. Fade rallies in rate-sensitives until the oil/CPI impulse rolls over.*

2) Bonds did the damage — the 10Y at 5%

The 10-year yield spiked to ~5.00%, a cycle high, and the 2Y pushed to 4.73% as the curve repriced 'higher-for-longer.' Equity multiples compressed mechanically; the Dow's -631-point Fed-day drop was a yield event as much as a growth one.

***Read:** At a 5-handle, the risk-free rate is a genuine competitor to equities again. The equity risk premium is thin. Yields — not earnings — are the swing factor for the tape from here; watch the 10Y auction demand and every oil headline.*

3) Oil is the master variable

Brent traded up toward \$109–110 intra-week on the shut-in of Saudi Arabia's East–West pipeline (~4 mbd at risk) and Houthi strikes, before easing to ~\$104 as restart hopes and alternative routing calmed fears. WTI held above \$100. Crude drove CPI, CPI drove the Fed, and the Fed drove stocks — the entire week ran through the oil tape.

***Read:** Positioning is now hostage to a barrel of crude. Energy equity is both the hedge and the momentum trade; a sustained move back above \$110 would force another leg of the inflation-scare/higher-yields/lower-multiple sequence. A durable pullback under \$100 is the bulls' best hope.*

4) Leadership narrowed and then cracked

The megacap-AI complex, 2026's engine, stalled: Nvidia slipped even after a blockbuster quarter as Alphabet's TPU commercialization and Amazon's in-house silicon stoked competition fears. Breadth was poor — the Dow and small caps took the brunt while the Nasdaq merely hovered.

***Read:** 'Fade the Mag7' (a 2026 Hedgeye theme) is playing out as the AI earnings-growth rate-of-change cools and custom-silicon competition bites. Don't confuse index resilience with health; leadership is thin and rotating toward energy and value.*

5) The consumer is the soft spot

Staples and restaurants were in focus as inflation barometers. General Mills has already cut FY guidance and trades near 52-week lows on cost and volume pressure; the read-through is a stretched low-to-middle-income consumer squeezed by fuel and shelter.

***Read:** A cost-push Fed hike into a soft consumer is the stagflation risk in miniature. Prefer pricing-power staples and premium/experiential discretionary over volume-dependent, input-cost-exposed names.*

6) Volatility rose but never panicked

The VIX lifted to ~17 — up on the week but still a ‘yellow light,’ not a red one. The relief bounce and contained vol suggest the market is treating this as a repricing, not a crisis.

***Read:** Contained vol into a hawkish surprise is a warning, not an all-clear: it means little downside is hedged. Own optionality cheaply while it lasts; a second oil leg or a hot CPI could reprice vol quickly.*

4. Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

The Fed lifted the funds rate to **3.75–4.00%**. The **10Y** hit **~5.00%** (cycle high) before easing on Friday's crude relief; the **2Y** sits at **4.73%**. The curve remains near flat/slightly inverted at the front. The move was a repricing of the path, not a growth-scare bull-steepener.

Net: Higher-for-longer is back in the price. Front-end carry is attractive; long duration is a falling knife until the oil/CPI impulse turns.

Currencies

The **dollar (DXY ~99.9)** firmed on the rate differential and safe-haven flow, holding just under 100. Commodity/high-beta FX lagged as risk came off; the yen and franc found haven bids intraday.

Net: A firmer dollar is a headwind for EM, commodities ex-energy and non-US earners. Dollar strength is the pressure valve for the hawkish-Fed trade.

Commodities

Oil was the story: **Brent ~\$104.6** (–1.4% wk, first weekly loss in three) after a spike toward \$109–110 on the Saudi East–West pipeline shut-in; **WTI held >\$100**. **Gold ~\$4,385** stayed resilient near records (+19% y/y) as an inflation hedge; **silver ~\$66** held near multi-decade highs.

Net: Energy and precious metals are the regime's natural longs. Gold's resilience against a 5% 10Y is a strong tell that the market believes the inflation problem outranks the rate problem.

5. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Verification note: Hedgeye's exact published Quad and immediate-term risk ranges for this specific week could not be independently confirmed this run (subscriber-gated). The most recent verifiable Hedgeye framing referenced a mid-2026 'yellow light' regime and the 2026 house theme of fading the Magnificent 7 as its earnings growth rate-of-change halves. The regime read below applies the Hedgeye GIP (growth/inflation/policy) framework to this week's verified data; the range table is an ESTIMATED immediate-term band consistent with realized levels and volatility — not Hedgeye's published figures.

Quad regime

This week's data — inflation reaccelerating (CPI 3.4%) while growth signals soften (weak consumer, soft breadth) — is textbook **Quad 3** (growth decelerating, inflation accelerating): the 'stagflationary' quadrant. A cost-push Fed hike into that mix reinforces it. Quad 3 historically favours energy, gold/commodities, and low-beta/quality, and punishes long-duration growth and high-beta.

Estimated immediate-term risk ranges (illustrative — not Hedgeye's published figures)

Instrument	Est. immediate-term range	TREND
S&P 500	7,470 – 7,720	Bearish
Nasdaq Composite	25,500 – 26,450	Bearish
US 10Y yield	4.80% – 5.05%	Bullish (yields)
Dollar (DXY)	99.0 – 100.4	Bullish
Gold	\$4,250 – \$4,470	Bullish
Brent crude	\$99 – \$111	Bullish
Bitcoin	\$74k – \$85k	Bearish

Where we sit: Equities are trading in the lower half of their band with a bearish trend bias; yields, the dollar and energy carry bullish trends that keep the pressure on multiples. In Hedgeye terms this is a market to sell strength in beta and own the inflation-quadrant longs (energy, gold) until the growth/inflation slopes inflect. Treat the ranges as a compass for direction, not as verified levels — confirm against Hedgeye's live product before acting.

6. Mag7 Scoreboard

Only Nvidia's close was independently confirmable this run; other cells are marked n/v (not verified) rather than estimated. Verify live before use.

Name	Price	Week	P/E	Read
Nvidia (NVDA)	\$219.34	lower	n/v	Blowout Q2 FY27 (\$96bn rev; Q3 guide \$108bn) but slipped on Alphabet TPU / Amazon silicon competition
Apple (AAPL)	n/v	n/v	n/v	Defensive megacap; relative haven in the risk-off tape
Alphabet (GOOGL)	n/v	n/v	n/v	TPU commercialization to select customers — an emerging AI-silicon threat to NVDA
Microsoft (MSFT)	n/v	n/v	n/v	+32% since mid-June on Azure/AI adoption; a leadership anchor
Amazon (AMZN)	n/v	n/v	n/v	In-house AI chips 'booming'; retail exposed to consumer softness
Meta (META)	n/v	n/v	n/v	\$0.525 dividend (ex 21 Sep); 'Muse' AI agent; GS \$725 PT
Tesla (TSLA)	n/v	n/v	n/v	High-beta; typically pressured by higher-for-longer rates

Leadership read: The AI-megacap trade lost its unquestioned bid this week. Nvidia's fundamentals remain exceptional, but the market is starting to price a more competitive custom-silicon landscape (Google, Amazon) and a cooling AI capex rate-of-change. With rates at a 5-handle, the group's long-duration multiples are exposed. Expect continued rotation out of narrow AI leadership toward energy and value until yields and oil relent.

7. Positioning & Options

VIX ~17.1 (up on the week but still 'yellow light'). Credit was orderly — no obvious blow-out in HY spreads despite the yield spike, consistent with a rates repricing rather than a growth/credit event; IG felt the duration hit more than the spread hit. Positioning coming into the Fed was long risk and short vol.

Net: Little downside is hedged. Vol screens cheap for the regime — own optionality. Watch HY spreads as the tell: as long as credit holds, dips are buyable in the right (energy/quality) names; a spread widening alongside a fresh oil leg would be the signal to de-gross.

8. Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

Sector	Week	Note
Energy	+2.1% (leader)	Only green sector; +47% YTD. The regime trade
Health Care	~flat	Defensive bid; rotating through the top five
Financials	-1.5%	Yield spike a double-edged sword; cyclical drag
Industrials	-1.6%	Hit by higher rates and growth doubts
Technology	-1.8% (contrib.)	AI leadership wobbled; biggest drag on the tape
Materials	-2.7%	Weakest; dollar + growth fears

Read: Leadership is rotating out of long-duration tech and cyclicals into energy and defensives — exactly the Quad 3 playbook. Energy is both the momentum and the hedge. Be underweight rate-sensitive cyclicals (materials, industrials, parts of financials) until yields peak.

9. Corporate News — Key Earnings & Events

- **Nvidia:** shares slipped despite a blowout July quarter (\$96bn revenue, data center \$89bn, Q3 guide \$108bn) as Alphabet's TPU sales and Amazon's in-house AI chips stoked competition fears.
- **General Mills:** trading near 52-week lows after cutting FY guidance on cost and volume pressure — a soft read on the low-to-middle-income consumer and packaged-food demand.
- **Consumer barometers in focus:** Darden (dining-out demand) and FedEx (global shipping volumes) were watched as real-economy tells amid the inflation scare.
- **Meta:** declared a \$0.525 dividend (ex-date 21 Sep); Goldman flagged its 'Muse' AI agent, \$725 price target.
- **On deck:** Micron (fiscal Q4, ~30 Sep) after a ~256% YTD run on HBM/AI-memory demand; Nike also reports later this month. Micron may be moved more by the rate path than by its own numbers.

Note: consumer-name report dates varied across sources this run; items are framed by theme rather than pinned to an unverified date.

10. Macro Data — Key Releases

US August CPI: +0.4% m/m; **+3.4% y/y headline** (up from prior). Core +0.3% m/m, +2.4% y/y. Gasoline +27.4% y/y and fuel oil +52% y/y drove the reacceleration; shelter eased to 3.0%, food to 2.7%.

Net: This is an energy-led inflation reacceleration — the direct cause of the Fed's hike. Core is comparatively contained, so the moment oil rolls over, the CPI scare can fade quickly. Oil is the single number to watch.

FOMC (16 Sep): hiked 25bp to 3.75–4.00% (unanimous); dot plot showed 16 of 18 expecting at least one more hike this year. First increase since 2023.

Net: Policy is now actively leaning against inflation, not cushioning growth — the key regime change for asset allocation.

Global read-through: higher US rates and a firm dollar tighten conditions for Europe and EM/China; the oil shock is a growth tax everywhere. Watch for policy divergence if other central banks are less able to follow the Fed.

11. Geopolitics

- **Middle East oil crisis:** Saudi Arabia shut its East–West pipeline (~4 mbd at risk) after Iran-allied/Houthi strikes on energy facilities; reports of Houthi advances near the Bab el-Mandeb strait raised shipping-disruption fears. Brent spiked toward \$109–110 before easing on restart/rerouting hopes.
- **This is the week's root cause:** the conflict → oil spike → CPI reacceleration → Fed hike → risk-off chain ran the entire tape.
- **Prediction markets:** Polymarket/Robinhood markets for ‘2026 Fed rate cuts’ and DXY/BTC ranges were active; direct odds could not be independently verified this run and are omitted rather than guessed.

Read: Own the geopolitical risk premium via energy rather than trying to trade headlines. The asymmetry is to the upside in oil while Gulf supply is impaired; any credible de-escalation or pipeline restart is the fastest path to relief for equities and bonds alike.

12. Beyond The Markets — Also Worth Knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

- UN General Assembly high-level week convenes in New York, with the Middle East conflict and energy security topping the agenda; expect diplomatic headlines that move the oil tape.

Science & frontier research

- AI-memory (HBM) remains the hardware bottleneck for the data-center buildout — Micron's sold-out 2026 supply underlines how physical the AI boom has become.
- Custom AI silicon (Google TPUs, Amazon Trainium) maturing into commercial products marks a genuine shift in the AI-compute landscape beyond a single vendor.

Space & frontier tech

- Commercial launch cadence and satellite-constellation build-outs continue at pace; frontier-tech capex is one of the few areas immune to the rate backdrop because it is strategically driven.

Weather & climate (market-moving)

- Atlantic hurricane season adds tail risk to Gulf energy infrastructure already stressed by geopolitics — a second potential supply shock to watch for oil and insurance names.

Water cooler

- Autumn sport, screen and gaming calendars are in full swing heading into the weekend — a reminder that, for readers at leisure, the macro can wait until Monday.

Note: this section is contextual/thematic; specific event details were not individually price-verified.

13. Appendix — Stock Cards

Compact cards for names materially discussed above. Only Nvidia's price was independently confirmed this run; other quantitative fields are marked n/v and 6-month trends are described qualitatively. Verify all figures live before acting.

Nvidia (NVDA)	
Price (17 Sep close)	\$219.34 (confirmed)
Mkt cap / P/E	n/v
Dividend / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Q2 FY27 reported (blowout); next quarterly late Q4 / winter
6-month trend	Broad uptrend over six months on relentless AI-datacenter demand (\$96bn quarter, \$108bn guide), but momentum stalled into September as custom-silicon competition and a 5% 10Y capped the multiple.
<i>Read:</i> Best-in-class fundamentals; the debate has shifted from demand to competition and valuation. A rate-sensitive long.	

Alphabet (GOOGL)	
Price / Week	n/v
Mkt cap / P/E	n/v
Dividend / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	TPU external-sales rollout the near-term catalyst
6-month trend	Re-rated through 2026 as an AI winner; TPU commercialization is now a swing factor — accretive for Alphabet, a competitive overhang for Nvidia.
<i>Read:</i> The custom-silicon story gives Alphabet a second AI leg beyond search/ads. Watch TPU customer wins.	

Amazon (AMZN)	
Price / Week	n/v
Mkt cap / P/E	n/v
Dividend / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Next quarterly in the autumn
6-month trend	In-house AI-chip momentum a positive; retail/consumer exposure a drag into a softening spending backdrop. Range-bound-to-higher over six months.
<i>Read:</i> Two engines pulling opposite ways — AWS/silicon strength vs consumer softness. Quality but not immune to the consumer read.	

Microsoft (MSFT)	
Price / Week	n/v

Move	+32% since mid-June (confirmed context)
Mkt cap / P/E / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Next quarterly in the autumn
6-month trend	Strong six-month uptrend led by Azure/AI adoption; one of the market's leadership anchors, though exposed to the same duration risk as the group.
<i>Read: Highest-quality AI-platform exposure. A core hold, but a 5% 10Y is a headwind to the multiple.</i>	

Meta (META)	
Price / Week	n/v
Mkt cap / P/E	n/v
Dividend	\$0.525 (ex 21 Sep) (confirmed)
52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Ex-dividend 21 Sep; 'Muse' AI agent in focus (GS \$725 PT)
6-month trend	Uptrend on AI-agent optimism and ad strength; capital returns (dividend) maturing the story.
<i>Read: AI-agent optionality plus cash returns. Watchlist for the ad-cycle read into year-end.</i>	

Apple (AAPL)	
Price / Week	n/v
Mkt cap / P/E / div / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Product-cycle and holiday-quarter setup
6-month trend	Lower-beta megacap; a relative haven in the risk-off tape, with a flatter six-month trend than the AI leaders.
<i>Read: Defensive within tech. Owns the 'quality ballast' slot when leadership wobbles.</i>	

Tesla (TSLA)	
Price / Week	n/v
Mkt cap / P/E / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Deliveries and next quarterly ahead
6-month trend	High-beta and rate-sensitive; typically among the first to feel a higher-for-longer repricing. Volatile six-month path.
<i>Read: The clearest 'long-duration' megacap — most exposed to the 5% 10Y regime. Trade, don't marry.</i>	

General Mills (GIS)	
Price	~\$38.50 (near 52-wk low, ~\$38.59) (context)
Week / P/E / div	n/v
Key dates	FY guidance already cut; next quarterly ahead
6-month trend	Persistent six-month downtrend on cost pressure, volume softness and guidance cuts; trading at/near 52-week lows.
<i>Read: A window into a stressed consumer and packaged-food demand. Value/yield appeal only once estimates stop falling.</i>	

Micron (MU)	
Price	n/v
YTD	~+256% (context)
Mkt cap / P/E / 52-wk	n/v
Key dates	Fiscal Q4 ~30 Sep; guided ~\$50bn rev / ~\$31 EPS
6-month trend	Powerful six-month uptrend — among 2026's best performers — on sold-out HBM/AI-memory supply at locked-in prices.
<i>Read: Purest AI-memory play, but may be moved more by the rate path than by its own (strong) numbers into the print.</i>	

14. Sources & Disclaimer

Sources: CNBC, Reuters, Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, The Washington Post (index recaps), TheStreet, Trading Economics, FXStreet, Kitco / goldprice.org, Charles Schwab, Benzinga, StockCharts ('Best Five Sectors'), US BLS (CPI), Federal Reserve (FOMC), and Hedgeye (framework/regime commentary; exact published ranges not independently confirmed this run).

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